The Future Of Work: 5 Important Ways Jobs Will Change In The 4th Industrial Revolution

In many respects, the future of work is already here. Amid the headlines exclaiming the predicted loss of jobs due to automation and other changes brought by artificial intelligence (AI), machine learning and autonomous systems, it's clear that the way we work and live is transforming. This evolution can be unnerving. Since we know change is inevitable, let's look at how work will likely change and some ideas for how to prepare for it.

At least 30% of the activities associated with the majority of occupations in the United States could be automated, which includes even knowledge tasks that were previously thought to be safe according to a McKinsey Global Institute report. This echoes what executives see as well and prompted Rick Jensen, Chief Talent Officer at Intuit to say, "The workforce is changing massively." Here are just a few of the ways:

Within an organization, positions will be more fluid, and a strict organizational chart will likely be tossed in favor of more project-based teams. This is especially appealing to Generation Z employees since 75% of Generation Z employees would be interested in having multiple roles in one place of employment. The "gig" economy will continue to expand where professionals sign on as contractors or freelancers and then move on to the next gig.

Thanks to mobile technology and readily available internet access, remote workers are already common. Employees won't need to be in the same location. This will make it easier for the next generation workers to choose to live anywhere, rather than find a job and then move to a city with that job.

People will need something more than a paycheck as a motivation to work. Many want to work for an organization with a mission and purpose they believe in. They will also want different incentives such as personal development opportunities, the latest tech gadgets to facilitate their work-from-anywhere ambitions, and more.

Not only will employees want to learn throughout their career, but they will also need to learn new skills. Technology will continue to evolve the role humans play in the workforce, so everyone will be required to adapt their skills throughout their working lives.

Artificial intelligence algorithms and intelligent machines will be co-workers to humans. The human workforce will need to develop a level of comfort and acceptance for how man and machine can collaborate using the best that both bring to the workplace.

Even though we can't predict all the changes that will occur in the future, we do have a fair amount of certainty that there are some things people can do to prepare for it. Rather than succumb to the doomsday predictions that "robots will take over all the jobs," a more optimistic outlook is one where humans get the opportunity to do work that demands their creativity, imagination, social and emotional intelligence, and passion.

Individuals will need to act and engage in lifelong learning, so they are adaptable when the changes happen. The lifespan for any given skill set is shrinking, so it will be imperative for individuals to continue to invest in acquiring new skills. The shift to lifelong learning needs to happen now because the changes are already happening.

In addition, employees will need to shape their own career path. Gone are the days when a career trajectory is outlined at one company with predictable climbs up the corporate ladder. Therefore, employees should pursue a diverse set of work experiences and take the initiative to shape their own career paths.

Individuals will need to step into the opportunity that pursuing your passion provides rather than shrink back to what had resulted in success in the past. This shift in work opens the possibility to achieve more of our potential. We need to begin to think of work as more than a paycheck.

Employers need to think differently about how they recruit and hire new employees. Companies need to review a prospective employee's potential and assess skills that are less likely to be automated any time soon, including emotional intelligence, critical thinking, creativity, and problem-solving skills.

Another way employers will need to adjust operations is to create a structure and culture that honors lifelong learning, and that celebrates creativity. It's time for employers to assess their benefit and incentive programs to ensure they are providing the motivation the next generation of employees will want in order to attract the best talent.

While nothing is certain, it's

important for every human to begin taking steps in the direction to prepare for a future where machines become colleagues. If we don't begin to adapt to the changes today, it will be challenging to catch up later.

Fonte:
https://www.forbes.com/2019/07/15

QUESTIONS

01. According to the text, questions related to the changes of how we work have evolved in such a way that it can be

A) encouraging.

B) insurmountable.

C) unsettling.

D) reassuring.

02. A report by the McKinsey Global Institute dealing with automation at work has brought evidence that

A) occupations in the education area will not be affected.

B) the major transformations occur in big companies.

C) no occupation is protected against changes.

D) industrial activities lead the rank of deepest changes.

03. Among the ways in which jobs will change, the text mentions

A) complete disappearance of many occupations.

B) scarcity of skilled professionals in certain areas.

C) motivation to work and continuous learning.

D) relentless persistence of old-fashioned ways of working.

04. In relation to the fluidity of positions in a company, the text mentions that this change would be an attractive feature mainly to

A) generation Z.

B) millennials.

C) generation X.

D) senior employees.

05. As to the presence of intelligent machines at the workplace, the text argues that it can

A) bring great discomfort to humans.

B) eliminate too many human jobs.

C) be very hazardous in many areas.

D) be integrated with the work of humans.

06. Amongst the transformations companies will go through, the text highlights a set of skills employers should be searching for when hiring new employees. It would be the ones that

A) make workers endure long working hours.

B) will not soon be done by a machine.

C) raise the profits, even if it is for just a short period.

D) contribute to a lifetime permanence at the company.

07. Still about the role of employers, the text mentions they will have to adjust the way they operate so that they are able to attract talented people to work in their company by, for instance,

A) building recreational areas for employees.

B) honoring a continued learning process.

C) creating family programs.

D) promoting weekend trips.

08. As to what employees could do to prepare for so many changes that are already happening, the text suggests, among other things,

A) investment in the acquisition of new abilities.

B) concentration on developing one specific skill.

C) focus on strategies that worked in the past.

D) hope that these changes will never reach them.

09. The sentence “If we don't begin to adapt to the changes today, it will be challenging to catch up later.” (lines 125-127) contains a

A) time clause.

B) contrastive clause.

C) conditional clause.

D) concessive clause.

10. In terms of voice of the verb, the sentences "...everyone will be required to adapt their skills throughout their working lives." (lines 59-60) and "This will make it easier for the next generation workers..." (lines 41-42) are, respectively, in the

A) active voice and active voice.

B) passive voice and passive voice.

C) active voice and passive voice.

D) passive voice and active voice.

11. In terms of verb tense, the sentences "...remote workers are already common." (lines 38-39) and "The workforce is changing massively." (lines 22-23) are, respectively, in the

A) present perfect and simple present.

B) simple present and present continuous.

C) present continuous and present continuous.

D) simple present and present perfect.

12. Regarding verb tense, the sentences "Employees won't need to be in the same location." (lines 39-40) and "...we do have a fair amount of certainty..." (line 70) are, respectively, in the

A) simple future and simple present.

B) future perfect and simple present.

C) future perfect continuous and simple future.

D) simple future and present continuous.

13. The text includes the ing-words "learning" (line 06), "transforming" (line 08), "unnerving" (line 09), "working" (line 60), and "thinking" (line 110) whose grammatical functions are respectively

A) verb, noun, adjective, verb, noun.

B) adjective, verb, verb, adjective, adjective.

C) noun, verb, adjective, adjective, noun.

D) noun, adjective, adjective, noun, verb.

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